If you want to switch to a different flight, you can check the ASK display to see whether a seat that meets your needs is available. If so, you can approach the airline on which you hold your current seat (`fromAirline`) and ask it to facilitate the change, specifying the airline to which you would like to switch (`toAirline`). Agents of the airlines process your request by using the ASK UI, assign the seat to you, and message you about the status of your transfer. Payment is settled between the airlines via the smart contract based on previously deposited amounts and any business contracts established between them.

Airlines interested in the ASK model join (register with) the ASK consortium by paying a deposit and applying to become ASK members. ASK member airlines are responsible for updating information about available seats on the ASK display board (off-chain data). ASK is designed for airlines that are not in preexisting partnerships, such as code-sharing alliances. If a customer who holds a seat wants to change to a different seat on a flight run by the same airline or a partner airline, the problem is not a blockchain problem; it can be solved within the airlines' conventional systems and databases.

The ASK display board shown in figure 6.12 has a list of available seats on flights operated by various airlines. The details include flight number, airline name, from city (origin), to city (destination), departure time, and number of seats available. Because the display will show only flights originating from the airport (city) where it is displayed, the origin city is redundant, but that's all right; we'll keep it there to establish the context. You might consider other business operations after you've mastered the concepts of blockchain, including displaying information on flights originating in other cities (airports) and using other request models (such as one-to-many or broadcast